

A customer focused, self-motivated & result oriented **Software Test Manager & Senior Test Consultant** having more than **9 years** of work experience of **Quality Engineering** vastly in area of **Banking and Financial Services** industry, specializing in **Payments & Core Banking**, having strong attention to details and strong track record of delivering major testing solutions for various IT and software development Projects of budget above £25m per year.

## PROFILE SUMMARY

- Software Testing and Quality Assurance professional with professional excellence in:
  - ~ Project Management
  - ~ Test Management
  - ~ Team Management
  - ~ Release Management
  - ~ Quality Engineering
  - ~ Cost & Efforts Estimation
  - ~ Stakeholder Management
  - ~ RAID Management
  - ~ Test Accelerators
  - ~ Test Optimization
  - ~ Test Automation
  - ~ Defect Management
  - ~ Test Consulting
  - ~ Liaison & Coordination
  - ~ Test Transformation
  - ~ Services Delivery
- Expert Test Manager and consultant who provides who provides Test Strategies and adaptable Test Plans
- Experienced in taking organization forward through implementing new target operating models and critical projects
- Strong ability to multi-task, manage shifting priorities, demands and timelines
- Excellent problem solving and analytical skills and ability to create timely fit for purpose solutions during tight timelines
- Expert in mentoring colleagues from various cultures and backgrounds and helping them being promoted in career path
- Comfortable talking on my feet leading workshops, roundtables and facilitating both pre and post implementation reviews
- Expertise with software development methodologies like V-Model, Waterfall, Agile, DevOps, Iterative, TDD & BDD
- Expertise in estimations, cost management, resource utilization with proactive project milestones tracking
- Skilled in automation test planning and authoring test documents, managing the quality assurance program in the organization, overseeing metrics data collection and efficiency measurements
- Comprehensive knowledge of Software Testing Life Cycle, Defect lifecycle, Release management, Manual & Automation Testing, Functional & Non-functional testing
- More than 8 years of experience in Client facing roles with onshore/ offshore model and team set-up across multiple locations
- More than 3.5 years of experience in onsite (United Kingdom) based management / lead roles
- Strong hands-on experience in working on Windows Servers, Web Technologies, Client/Server, RDBMS, Mainframes, Functional & Non-functional Testing, ALM, JMeter, Selenium Webdriver, CTD, RTC, JIRA & Microsoft Project/ Office Suite
- Excellent Business analysis & Gap Analysis skills to identify, challenge, rectify and implement testing based on Business processes and technical impacts associated with firm understanding of as-is, to-be, transitional and migration based approach
- Spearheaded the design and led the test strategy, test plan, execution, reporting and closure for all projects & completed review activities such as requirements review, design review, test strategy review and test case/ scripts review
- An effective leader with excellent communication, negotiation, motivational and relationship building skills
- Experienced in working within multi-vendor environment and promoting one team culture to maintain sustainable work environment for client's and organizational success
- Organizing and contributing in various continuous improvement drives by implementing various proof of concepts, ROIs, Test Transformation Business cases and Testing accelerators

## KEY FUNCTIONAL & TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Industry:** Banking and Financial Services, Media & Entertainment

**Functional Area:** **Retail Banking** - Core Banking (UNISYS & SAP Banking Services), Banking Products & Accounts, Mediated and Non-mediated Banking Channels (Branch, Postal, Digital Banking, Mobile Banking, Telephone Banking, Open / API Banking), Services Origination, Anti Money Laundry, Hot List Scanning (Fircosoft), Proactive Risk Management, Financial Crime (Actimize), Credit Scoring (Experian), Statements & Customer Communication (Communis), Document & Asset Management, Product Switch & Current Account Switching Service (CASS)

**Payments Processing** - Faster Payments, Direct Debit, Standing Orders, BACS, SWIFT, CHAPS, SEPA, High Value Payments, Bank Giro, Cash, Paym, Mobile Payments, LINK, VISA, Cheque Clearing, Cheque Image clearing, Electronic Payments, Pay by Bank App, Credit Card payments, Debit Card payments, Contactless Card payments, Digital Payments (Apple Pay, Samsung Pay, Android Pay), Digital Wallet, Verifone Merchant Payments (Payware), ATM Services, Mobile Phone Top ups, Payment Gateways (VOCALINK, PayPort, HSBC, IBDE, IPSL, BACS & TSYS), VISA Fast Funds, Wire Transfers, financial & technical reconciliations (Accurate NXG, BankRec), Settlements

**Investment Banking** - Treasury Management, Investment & Debt Management, Cash Flow Management, Cash Flow Forecasting, FX Management, Trade Management, Asset Management & Risk Management

**Internet and Broadcasting Media** - Content Management System, Advertisements, Publishing & Broadcasting

**SDLC:** V-Model, Waterfall, Iterative, Agile (Kanban & Hybrid) and DevOps

**Tools:** Microsoft Project, EPM, ProjectLibre, HP Application Lifecycle Management, JIRA, Zephyr, Rational Team Concert, Visio, SharePoint, MS Office Suite, Eclipse, Apache JMeter, Selenium Webdriver, Cucumber BDD, IDE, HP UFT, MATLAB, Simulink, Load Runner, FOCUS, RPT, RFT, T3 Iliad, CA's Test Data Manager and Agile Requirements Designer, Java SDK, HTTP Analyzer, Attachmate InfoConnect, Verifone Payware, VOCALINK PayPort, T3 Account Switch Iliad, ComForte MR-Win6530, LEXCEL LINK Simulator, VISA Test Simulator, SoapUI, MS Test Manager, ACI Base24, IBM FOCUS, WAPT

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|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Platforms:</b>          | MS Team Foundation Server, VSTS, BizTalk Server, SQL Server, SSIS, SSAS and SSRS, IIS, Oracle's OLAP Data Warehouse, .NET Framework, Java Runtime Environments, MS Virtual Machines, Java Virtual Machine, HP NonStop Tandem, IBM WebSphere MQ                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Languages:</b>          | C, Java, VB Script, JavaScript, XML, UML, SQL, HTML, Python, TACL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Test Methodologies:</b> | Combinatorial Test Design, Pairwise Testing, Orthogonal Array Test System, Equivalence Partitioning, Boundary Value Analysis, Classification Tree, Decision Table, State Transition, Use Case Testing, Code Integration Testing, System Testing, System Integration Testing, User Acceptance Testing, Performance Testing, Security Testing, Compliance Testing, Operational Acceptance Testing, Static & dynamic testing, Risk based testing, Regression Testing, Black Box & White box testing, Exploratory Testing, Data Driven Testing, Keyword Driven Testing, Model Based Testing, Process driven Testing, Pattern based testing, |
| <b>Estimation Models:</b>  | Work Breakdown Structure, GTEF, Function Points, Time & Material, Fixed Price                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Artefacts:</b>          | Test Estimations & Resource Profiles, Test Tooling Approach, Test Automation Approach, Test Environments and Data Approach, Test Strategy, Test Plan, Test Quality Gates, Test Scripts & Programs, Project Metrics, Test Execution & Test Outcome Reports, Portfolio updates reports, Demand and forecast reports, Plan on a page                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

## ORGANISATIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### *Payments Portfolio Test Manager*

June 2015 – Till date

**IBM India Pvt Ltd**

*Advisory IT Specialist*

*Client: Nationwide Building Society, UK*

Leading a team of 30+ Test Analysts, Test Leads & project Test Managers across various payments projects & production releases aiming technological advancements and implementations

- *Payments Portfolio Projects:* Led end to end testing development and delivery of major industry specific payments projects (regulatory & nonregulatory) like, Future Cheques, SEPA Compliance, Open Banking, Digital Banking Resilience, Services Origination, De-risk hybrid banking, PSD2 Regulations, VISA & LINK Enhancements, VISA Technical Integration, VISA Disputes, ATM Dynamic Routing, LINK Noncash & Charitable Giving, VISA Claims Resolution Compliance, CASS Indefinite Redirection, HSBC FlexRate, Digital Payments (Apple Pay, Android Pay & Samsung Pay), Wire Transfer Regulations, SHA2 Upgrades, VOCALINK AMR, VOCALINK PayPort (PGMS), Contactless Cards, Recommend a Friend & various Infrastructure upgrade projects
- *Payments Development Center Releases:* System Testing & Application Integration Testing of Standard, custom and small change releases related to more than 20 payment specific systems.

### **Achievements:**

- Achieved highest TM capability score (5/5) and highest CSQ (Client Satisfaction Quotient) score (4/4) in Testing Services organization of 750+ team members
- Successfully implemented various test accelerators (CTD, TAC, Test Harnesses, Automation, virtualization, Cognitive Analysis, Defect Prediction) across various projects and got the team members recognized by customer
- Lead the testing efficiency, testing effectiveness & continuous improvement drives
- Delivered testing solutions for 3-4 regulatory projects with similar timescales running in parallel without any failure
- Managed best resource profile with core and flex skill sets and lowest attrition rates, onshore offshore ratio and balanced team pyramids based on target structure
- Achieved highest CSL success rates across the whole Testing Services organization of size 750+
- Maintained the best of payments team ever with highest level of motivations, and maximum knowledge / capability retention rate
- Effortlessly managed delivery with 15+ project managers, program managers, senior managers at the same time
- Recognized and highly valued by client to implement fast track testing solutions for various emergency instances

### *Test Lead*

Sep 2011 – May 2015

**IBM India Pvt Ltd**

*Senior IT Specialist*

*Client: Nationwide Building Society, UK*

Led a team of 5-15 (varying) team members across various major projects like: Voyager Programme (Core Banking Transformation from Unisys to SAP Banking), PSD2012 Faster Payments, HSBC FX Automation, Fraud Control Implementation on CHAPS SWIFT Payments, Paym, Server Transformation, Hotlist Scanning, Regional Brand Mortgage Migration & Integration Programme and various small-scale enhancements

### **Achievements:**

- Successfully developed Automated regression scripts for Faster Payments (PSD2012) in co-ordination with Microsoft and conducted various rounds of successful regression testing using the same, authored Technical Guides
- Successfully conducted Exploratory and Additional Acceptance Testing phases for PSD2012 on the top of usual System Test, SIT & UAT phase
- Successfully delivered various testing phases (ST, SIT & UAT) along with testing of Bank & Customer Journey in Nationwide's largest IT transformation programme (Voyager) which moved core banking from Unisys to SAP
- Took various onshore based client facing & lead roles in UK and delivered functional testing of various Payments projects
- Implemented testing accelerators in various Payments applications using CTD and Automation based approach

- Attained Engagement lead role in CTD and conducted training for 100+ resources and enabled 50+ CTD practitioners
- Introduced & stabilized CTD Operating Model in Nationwide and implemented pilots/ PoC's and won client's trust & confidence
- Successfully delivered end to end testing solutions (from estimations to closure) for various payments projects in both regulatory and nonregulatory space
- Efficiently managed to implement Payments Testing Strategy and associated Testing Governance
- Successfully managed demand and capacity, estimations, resource allocation & utilization for Payments Releases

#### **Senior Test Specialist**

Aug 2009 – Aug 2011

#### **IBM India Pvt Ltd**

IT Specialist

**Clients:** 1. Citigroup Inc, USA

2. Nationwide Building Society, UK

Led a team of approx 5 testers in Citigroup project and delivered a number of client facing roles.

Key Projects worked on: TreasuryVision BAU Release, Auto Billing, Debt & Investment Subscription (Citi).

Tranche Savings Products, Voyager Programme, PSD2012 (Nationwide)

#### **Achievements:**

- Successfully transitioned knowledge of Citi's applications in scope with reverse KT and documented AIDs and ASCPs
- Demonstrated and implemented HTTP Analyzer based web-part performance monitoring at Citi
- Successfully completed regression testing and scripts baselining using QTP 9.5 at Citi
- Completed Function Point analysis based Testing estimations for various applications in scope at Citi
- Contributed in back-end ETL testing for Oracle's OLAP based Citi's Global Information Warehouse
- Managed to complete infused Transition of key & complex Payments applications and developed numbers of AIDs at Nationwide
- Worked on WBS based Test estimations, Test Plans, Test Briefing packs, preparation & execution at Nationwide
- Successfully implemented Build Verification Testing of Internet Bank using QTP 10 at Nationwide

#### **Test Specialist**

Aug 2008 – July 2009

#### **IBM India Pvt Ltd**

Associate IT Specialist

**Clients:** 1. VRT, Belgium

2. Times Internet Limited, India

Key Projects worked on: VRT Broadcasting platform upgrade, CMS Remediation (Delphi/.NET) and CMS Re-platforming (Java / J2EE)

#### **Achievements:**

- Achieved solid contributor rating in my first year of service
- Successfully analyzed, developed and implemented performance benchmarking (baselining) of ET Quotes & other web applications and identified key bottlenecks using Rational Performance Tester and JMeter tool
- Recognized by client for successful implementation of URL sequence and server monitoring using QEngine ManageEngine Application Manager tool and Regression / baseline testing using the same tool
- Successfully completed testing of MediaGen web services using JMeter and RFT
- Performed Requirement Analysis, Gap analysis, Test Planning, Preparation and Execution of associated projects

## **QUALIFICATIONS & TRAININGS**

~ISTQB Certified

~IBM Certified CTD Coach

~IBM Certified Agile Practitioner

~IBM Certified Cognitive Practitioner

~IBM Big Data & Analytics Training

~IBM LEAN Six Sigma Certified

~IBM Certified Design Thinking

Practitioner

~IBM Leadership Training

~IBM Project Management Training

~IBM Blockchain Essentials

~Data Science Foundations

~IBM ThinkAcademy Courses

~NPTEL, MIT OCW Courses

~Coursera, eDX, Udemy & CodeAcademy

## **RECOGNITIONS & AWARDS**

~IBM Eminence & Excellence - Spark

~Nationwide's PRIDE Awards

~IBM Eminence & Excellence - Orion

~Citigroup's Star of the Month Awards

~IBM Service Excellence Recognition

~IBM Honor Recognition

## **EDUCATION**

- B.Tech (Electrical & Electronics Engineering) from Cochin University of Science And Technology (Kochi, Kerala) in 2004

## **INTERESTS**

~Blockchain

~Big Data, Data Science & Analytics

~Artificial Intelligence & Cognitive

~Internet of Things

~Photography (Travel, Candid & Wedding)

~Touring, Reading, Blogging & Teaching